The Busy Page

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 3

The keeper's page mentioned weather, a picnic, and observations from two water points. Nib chose the picnic as the most promising detail. Lark enjoyed its sandwich drawing, then placed the quiet-brook question beside the page. The most interesting sentence was not necessarily the one that helped answer it.

“The picnic is an excellent detail,” Nib insisted. “An excellent detail for another question,” Lark replied kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **inlet**

“A main idea must fit the useful details,” Lark explained gently. “First ask what question we are trying to answer. Then read for the sentences that bear on it. We can enjoy the picnic without treating it as evidence about the water route.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try inlet, outlet, branch. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the short page, then find its two water observations,” Lark invited gently. “Which detail belongs to another topic?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The inlet is wet. The outlet is dry. A cake is on the mat.**

“Which two sentences help with the water question?” Lark asked gently. “Which one tells us something else?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The page placed water at one recorded point and none at the other. Lark underlined those sentences after the reading. They narrowed the question to the route between the points. Neither sentence yet showed what had changed that route. Nib left the picnic drawing in its margin, interesting and properly separate.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write inlet beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal gained a smaller question, supported by the right details. The crew would need an observation that could distinguish a dry supply from water taking a different path.